CF Bulk Upload – Empty Cell Clears Field

Proposal from the lead: on UPDATE, an empty cell empties the field, replacing the `#CLEAR` token. It suits the report round-trip, but it changes how IDs, required fields and missing columns behave.

Update, 14 Oct 2026: decided and built with all six suggestions below (`#CLEAR` now fails the row; the Assets title is kept).

The change

Only the empty-cell row changes; CREATE is unaffected, because an empty cell there already means an empty field.

Cell on an UPDATE row	Today	Proposed
Has a value	Field set to the value	Same
Empty (column is in the sheet)	Field kept as it is	**Field emptied**
`#CLEAR`	Field emptied	Dropped (decision 4)
Column not in the sheet	Field kept	Field kept (decision 1)

It fits the report workflow: the report already holds every current value, so deleting a value in Excel means "remove it".

Impact

The main risk is clearing data by accident; the rest are edge cases the new rule has to define.

#	Area	What happens under the new rule	Suggested handling
1	Columns left out of the sheet	If missing columns also cleared fields, a small sheet (e.g. only `label`) would wipe every other field	Not in the sheet = not touched
2	ID field	An empty `offerID` on UPDATE would clear the ID; `offer-card.id` isn't required, so it would really be removed	Empty ID on UPDATE = keep the ID
3	Required fields	An empty required field on UPDATE now means "clear it"	Row fails: `offerTitle: required`
4	Old `#CLEAR` cells	If simply dropped, `#CLEAR` would be written into the field as text	Reject with "#CLEAR is no longer used — leave the cell empty" (or treat as empty)
5	Fragment title	An empty title field (e.g. `offerTitle`) clears the field; the title shown in Assets could follow or stay	Keep the fragment's current title
6	Accidental clearing	Deleting a value by mistake is now easy and silent	List cleared fields in the results, dry run included: `…/book-now (cleared: deeplink)`
7	Columns not in the model	Empty cells now count, so a wrong column fails its rows even when empty	Accept: stricter and safer

Code impact is small: only the writer changes (it walks the sheet's headers instead of the filled cells), plus the spec and the page's help text.

Decisions needed

Our suggestion is in brackets; numbers refer to the Impact table.

- ☐ Column not in the sheet = field kept? (yes) — 1
- ☐ Empty ID on UPDATE = ID kept? (yes) — 2
- ☐ Empty required field on UPDATE = row fails? (yes) — 3
- ☐ Old `#CLEAR`: reject with a message, or treat as empty? (reject) — 4
- ☐ Fragment title: keep, or follow the field? (keep) — 5
- ☐ Show cleared fields in the results? (yes) — 6